

of Jesus Christ” (a reference to the four Gospels, presumably). The objective was conversions in all ethnic nations; only the Word of God could achieve that. To reach all nations, that Word would have to be translated into their languages; “the command of the eternal God” includes a world-wide distribution!

Now consider 1 Corinthians 2:13, “which things we also expound, not in words taught by human wisdom, but in those taught by the Holy Spirit”. Paul plainly declares that he received instruction from the Holy Spirit. And now 1 Corinthians 14:37, “If anyone thinks that he is a prophet or spiritual, let him acknowledge that the things I write to you are the Lord’s commands”. Was Paul on an ego trip, or was he aware that he was writing under inspiration? Since he says something similar in a number of his letters, it is clear that he believed he was writing Scripture. Like in Galatians 1:11-12. “Now I want you to know, brothers, that the Gospel preached by me is not according to man; because I did not receive it from any man, nor was I taught it; rather it came through a revelation from Christ.” The plain meaning of these verses is that Paul is claiming revelation, and that he received it directly from the glorified Christ!

Ephesians 3:5, “which in different generations was not made known to the sons of men, as it has now been revealed by the Spirit to His holy apostles and prophets.” Paul declares that the Holy Spirit gave Revelation to various people. An apostle, upon receiving a revelation, would also function as a prophet, but people like Mark and Luke were prophets without being apostles. Colossians 1:25-26, “the Church, of which I became a servant according to the stewardship from God that was given to me towards you, to **complete** the Word of God, the secret that has been hidden from past ages and generations, but now has been revealed to His saints.” The normal and central meaning of the Greek verb here, πληρωω, is precisely ‘to complete’, not ‘to fulfill’, or something similar. Why reject the normal meaning? Paul declares that God commissioned him to write Scripture! In fact, God caused fourteen of his epistles to be included in the NT Canon.

1 Thessalonians 2:13, “when you received from us the spoken Word of God, you welcomed it not as the word of men but, as it actually is, the Word of God”. Paul refers to the speaking or applying of the Word, emphasizing its divine origin. 2 Thessalonians 2:15 also deals with the authority of God’s Word, whether spoken or written.

It is clear that Paul expected his writings to have a wider audience than just the particular church addressed. In fact, in Galatians 1:2 he addresses “the churches of Galatia”; not to mention 2 Corinthians 1:1, “all